SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

KEY DRIVERS OF ENROLLMENT IN BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION PROGRAMS: THE CASE OF SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

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Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Marketing Management

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CHAPTER I

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Business Administration programs train future leaders to deal with the fast changes happening in the economy, society, and technology. At Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), these programs, such as Financial Management, Human Resource Management, Operations Management, Marketing Management, and Business Economics, help students develop thinking, management, and leadership skills that are important for national progress. The Philippine Statistics Authority (2024) reported that Business Administration is one of the most popular courses in the country. However, many schools, especially in the provinces, have trouble understanding the main drivers of enrollment, which results in poor recruitment and unstable student numbers. At SMCC, the Business Administration program continues to attract many students, but the exact drivers behind this remain unclear.

International studies have found several drivers that influence students' enrollment in Business Administration programs. Career development theories say that students choose their course based on different factors such as the value of the program, its availability, the reputation of the teachers, and job opportunities after graduation (Lamichhane et al., 2022; Naveed & Khurshid, 2021). Studies from Indonesia, Malaysia, South Africa, and Vietnam show that academic reputation, financial concerns, and future careers are the most common drivers of enrollment (Govender & Law, 2025; MULYONO et al., 2020; Norizan et al., 2023; Wickneswary et al., 2024). Institutional factors like the school's mission and vision, admission process, student support, and financial help also play an important role (Karn & Kumari, 2023; Maddah, 2021). Other drivers include parents' influence, school fees, learning conditions, location, and government policies (Budhathoki, 2024; Chhor et al., 2024; Por et al., 2024).

In the Philippines, many studies have looked into what affects students' choice of programs. Choosing a career is often hard for Filipino students because there are many options and social expectations, along with limited career guidance and financial problems (Palattao, 2025). Factors such as personal interest, parental support, financial ability, and distance from school strongly affect their decision to enroll (Bajar & Gopun, 2021; Baulete et al., 2022; Rosali et al., 2024). Other important drivers include tuition fees, scholarships, quality of lessons, teachers' competence, and school facilities (Aligora, 2023; Calma & Abiog, 2020; Ventolero, 2021). Studies also show that marketing efforts, student satisfaction, alumni support, and community activities help schools keep steady enrollment (Cabeliza, 2021).

Understanding why students enroll in specific academic programs remains an important concern for higher education institutions, especially within local settings such as the Caraga Region. At Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), examining the factors that drive students to choose the Business Administration program is essential for responding to enrollment patterns and strengthening institutional development. Local research shows that students' academic choices are shaped by both personal contexts**,** such as self-confidence and interests, and environmental contexts**,** including their perceptions of a profession (Alcontin et al., 2024). These findings align with the realities in Caraga, where students often rely on family influence, career expectations, and the reputation of local institutions when selecting a course. Therefore, identifying the key drivers of BSBA enrollment at SMCC is necessary to enhance program offerings and better address the needs and motivations of learners in the region.

Given these contexts, examining the specific case of St. Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) is essential. While Business Administration programs in general are widely recognized as valuable, there is a noticeable lack of empirical research that focuses on the specific factors influencing

students to enroll in SMCC's Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) program. Understanding these drivers is crucial for the college as it continues to position itself as a competitive institution for business education in the region.

This study aims to identify and analyze the primary factors that influence students' decisions to choose the BSBA program at SMCC. The results will serve as a basis for improving SMCC's strategies in program promotion, student engagement, and institutional development. Additionally, the study intends to provide insights that can support the alignment of SMCC's business program with local industry demands and global business trends.

The findings of this study will benefit several groups connected to SMCC and its BSBA program. For SMCC administrators, the results can guide the improvement of marketing and recruitment strategies, faculty development, and overall program branding to enhance competitiveness and support informed decisions on resource allocation and long-term planning. For the CBM department, the study will provide insights into the program features that attract or discourage students, allowing for targeted enhancements in teaching approaches, internship opportunities, and partnerships with local businesses to better address student needs and industry requirements. Current and prospective students, along with their parents, will gain clearer information about the strengths and relevance of the SMCC BSBA program, helping them make informed choices about their educational and career paths. Finally, the local community and industry partners will benefit from a stronger alignment between the BSBA program and local economic demands, resulting in graduates who are better prepared for employment and entrepreneurship and who can contribute meaningfully to regional development.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This section was associated with literature and research, which favored the overall topic of the research. The researcher collected materials about enrollment in business administration programs and key drivers.

The enrollment by the students in business administration programs has been indicated to be based on various drivers, such as marketing strategies and institutional characteristics. In Zambia, a research study found that even with a low rate of promotional approach adoption, such marketing technologies as websites, social media, and word-of-mouth were significant factors in student enrollment (Sikalumbi et al., 2023). Likewise, a study in Germany has shown that the content of the programs, the flexibility, and support services had a significant impact on the intention to join, meaning that institutional factors other than promotion played a significant role in determining the success of enrollment (Toussaint et al., 2025).

The significance of interpersonal influence and leadership in the enrollment decisions in the other studies has also been underscored. A study among applicants to MBA programs revealed that informal sources of leadership, including alumni, peers, and mentors, had a decisive effect on enrollment decisions and frequently exceeded the impact of formal advertising (Mickler Jr., 2021). Supporting this, research on startups identified both internal drivers, including technical and relational skills, and external drivers, such as governance and institutional support, as essential for success, underscoring the role of leadership and institutional environment in shaping outcomes (Saba et al., 2025).

Marketing strategies have also been studied as central to enrollment in higher education. In Nigeria, social media marketing was shown to have a measurable effect on enrollment growth in private universities, with targeted online advertisements and interactive campaigns significantly influencing student decision-making (Olumeru et al., 2024). Likewise, in Indonesia,

evidence indicated that social media marketing increased student enrollment and contributed to student retention, demonstrating the dual role of digital strategies in attracting and sustaining students (Siminto et al., 2024). These studies affirm that the interaction of marketing strategies, program quality, interpersonal influence, and institutional factors drives business program enrollment. This provides the foundation for the present study at Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Age

Several studies have studied how age influences the transition between secondary and tertiary education. According to (Enciso & De Sesto, 2025), the age of students is one of the developmental stages that contributes to the decision to attend college, as well as financial and institutional aspects. Equally, (Firmalino et al., 2020) discovered that the course decisions of senior high school students were influenced by academic performance, parental influence, and financial considerations. However, readiness moderates their choices according to age. (Sierra & Pepito, 2024) also included was the fact that there was a strong relationship between the perceptions of the K-12 Program and first-year college preparedness, once again demonstrating that age is an inherent facet of preparedness. These studies highlight the effects of the developmental stage, age, and academic and social support on students' higher education trajectories.

The quantitative methods also demonstrate that age is important in enrollment behaviors. In a binary classification model, (Esquivel & Esquivel, 2020) found that age, geographic, and demographic factors predicted the chances of enrolling in a Philippine university. (Monaghan, 2021) also found that background factors, social origins, and academic preparation significantly impacted enrollment among students of traditional age, but this decreased in significance after age 24. In the case of older students, marital dissolution, marital disruption, and loss of employment were more predictive factors of enrollment. The results imply that enrollment

patterns are not homogeneous throughout life, and age interacts with the social and individual variables.

Lastly, studies involving adult learners reveal the impact of age on learning styles and motivations. According to (Ampler et al., 2024), the totality of experiences influences adult learners in terms of readiness and orientation to learn. The strongest predictor of learning styles was intrinsic motivation, and most often learning styles were kinesthetic. Thus, age identifies developmental readiness among the youth and determines how adults utilize adult learning opportunities. These lessons confirm age-sensitive learning methods that address the needs of younger learners who join higher education and adult learners who return to school.

Sex

Sex plays a crucial role in shaping enrollment patterns and academic experiences in Business Administration programs in the Philippines. De Vera (2024) reported through sex-disaggregated data analysis that female students consistently outnumber male students in BSBA Marketing Management programs, indicating higher participation and retention among women. Similarly, Usita and Dela Cruz (2025) found that societal expectations influence course selection, with male and female students often following different pathways in business and professional education. These findings underscore the importance of sex as a factor influencing enrollment trends and academic decision-making within Business Administration programs.

Institutional structures also influence gendered educational experiences. Tugonon and Adlawan (2025) noted that male faculty often occupy administrative and research leadership roles, while female faculty are more concentrated in teaching positions, which may shape students' perceptions of career progression. In addition, Ballados and Guevarra (2020) emphasized that gender-responsive institutional practices affect students' access to resources

and economic opportunities. Micabalo et al. (2020) also found that internship participation and outcomes differ by sex due to social and cultural factors. These studies demonstrate that enrollment patterns are shaped not only by individual preferences but also by institutional and structural conditions.

Sex further influences skill development, specialization choices, and professional trajectories. Tan and Arceo (2024) and Cabusao (2023) reported that although female students participate actively in entrepreneurship programs, sex moderates the relationship between personality traits and entrepreneurial competencies. Santos and Soliven (2025) found that women are more likely to enroll in accounting programs but may encounter barriers related to mentorship and leadership opportunities. Similarly, Santos and Nagaño (2025) showed that sex predicts course selection in hospitality and business-related fields. Dela Cruz (2024) also highlighted the unique challenges and opportunities encountered by women entrepreneurs. Collectively, these studies confirm that sex is a significant driver of enrollment, academic pathways, and professional outcomes in Business Administration programs.

Household Income

Household income has consistently been identified as a major factor influencing college enrollment and student decision-making. Leukhina (2023) emphasized that family income predicts not only whether students enroll in college but also the type of institution they select, as well as their long-term academic and professional outcomes. Similarly, Tompsett and Knoester (2023) found that socioeconomic status, including household income, shapes both the likelihood of college attendance and the opportunities available to students once enrolled. Research on high-achieving, low-income students highlights that financial constraints often lead students to

"undermatch," enrolling in less selective colleges than their academic credentials would allow (MDPI, 2020). These findings illustrate that household income is a critical determinant of access to higher education and participation in academic programs.

In the Philippine context, household income has a direct influence on institutional choice and perceived affordability. Bajar and Gopun (2021) reported that family income significantly affects students' decisions when choosing a private higher education institution, with higher-income families more able to prioritize institutional reputation, facilities, and program offerings. Similarly, Pagulayan et al. (2025) found that economic capital, including parental income, contributes to college readiness, which in turn affects students' ability to succeed in higher education. These studies underscore that household income does not only impact enrollment but also shapes preparedness, expectations, and engagement with academic programs, making it a key factor in educational planning and decision-making.

Financial capacity also plays a decisive role in program selection, especially in private or fee-based institutions. Research conducted at Columban College (2025) revealed that tuition costs and family financial resources are among the primary considerations for senior high school students deciding whether to pursue higher education. Students from higher-income households are more likely to enroll in programs they perceive as valuable and attainable, whereas lower-income students may face barriers or delays due to cost considerations. Collectively, these studies demonstrate that household income is a significant driver of enrollment, institutional choice, and academic engagement, suggesting that in the context of Saint Michael College of Caraga, income is likely a critical factor influencing students' decisions to enroll in the BSBA program.

Parental Influence

Parental influence is one of the important factors in a student's program selection. This is based on the values, experiences, and beliefs instilled in the student by the parents, which become the foundation for selecting the program (Corey & Chen, 2019; Wang, 2025). Parental influence is related to parent-child attachment, parent support, and parenting style; thus, parental influence plays a significant role in career choice.

Recent research in the Philippines and other countries proves parental influence is a key determinant in students' program and career choice. In addition, (Lalantacon et al., 2024) revealed that parental involvement and cultural attitudes are most strongly related to career choices in ABM strand students, who are inclined to continue in business programs. (Abalos et al., 2024) also provided that the level of parental education and income strongly impacts the career choices of senior high school students.

The parents' approval and expectations have also been found to be important. Parental consent and parental permission were the prevalent determinants of course choice per (Sadjail et al., 2022). (Lozano, 2024) noted that parental involvement was essential during pandemic home learning to guide Grade 12 students in their career choices, which is another way to show that Family support is strongly correlated with the selected program in learners. Career practices among parents also increase students' confidence when making decisions regarding tertiary education. (Baldon et al., 2023) established that supportive parental behaviors positively impact career decision self-efficacy, which assists a learner in making a more resolute commitment to the selected programs. Abu (2023) also added that the parent occupation and social prestige associated with the occupation were significant factors that caused students to pursue business in Ghana.

According to Leighton & Speer, 2025 also found that a strongly influencing factor in college primary choice is the family background, and economic benefits and parental education affect students in fields with higher incomes. Socioeconomic factors also explain enrollment decisions. Of importance. (Tag-at, 2025) discovered that parents' education level and income are significantly linked to their motives of sending children to private institutions, which are aimed at career preparation in the future and the institution's reputation. (Nisola, 2025) also revealed that parental education, socioeconomic status, and family structure contributed to the exit routes and future enrollment into college programs.

Peer Influence

Due to their disadvantaged backgrounds, young people tend to participate in activities that enrich their education only during school; most of their time is spent on unstructured activities at home or in the company of peer groups (Bandura, 1986). Students can be affected by their peers' program choices, sometimes taking the wrong direction and choosing something that fails to match their interests. It is also a time of conflict between the influence of the family, old habits of leisure, and new preferences under the impact of the peer network (Boye, 2024). In this background, parental expectations and support remain crucial, although peer relationships shape enrollment choices and career options.

The literature review evidence indicates that peer influence has been reported to influence enrollment, persistence, and academic achievement, even though the conceptualization has varied with different contexts. Peer influence in France was measured with the help of the percentage of peers who were negatively assessed regarding university applications, and this measure significantly decreased the chances of admission, especially in the case of weaker students academically (Pistolesi, 2022). Other research on middle school music participation in the United States found that peer support and discussion were significant to staying motivated to

continue in ensembles. However, parental impact was the more significant predictor of re-enrollment (Holster, 2023). In line with these findings, a large-scale study in China has concluded that peer relationships' direct and indirect positive effects on academic performance in youths at junior high schools were present and that learning motivation and engagement were mediating variables (Shao et al., 2024).

In addition to formal education, peer networks have been reported to play a fundamental role in program involvement and higher education access. Peer support in the case of syringe services program enrollment made enrollment into programs possible in Appalachian Kentucky, as the participants were reassured, accompanied, and encouraged to talk about stereotypes, which helped them eliminate the fear of stigmatization (Ibragimov et al., 2021). Similarly, the first-generation rural college students in the United States also reported having peers giving them transportation services, resources, and comparative motivations, thus complementing the support of family and mentors in accessing higher education (Whiteside, 2021).

Future Success Influencing

Business Administration programs teach students various aspects of business, including finance, marketing, operations, accounting, and human resource management. They develop technical expertise and soft skills like leadership, critical thinking, and communication. These programs also provide practical administrative skills, job connections, higher compensation rates, career milestones, and exposure to diverse workplace environments. In line with this, (Caliat et al., 2023), academic programs should address community and market needs, providing a reference for applying marketing knowledge in the real world and aligning with student and employer expectations.

According to (De Guzman et al., 2020) and (Abella et al., 2022) found that graduates from Pangasinan State University-Lingayen are work-based, valuing qualities like integrity,

communication, and shared responsibility. (Abella et al., 2022) also noted that graduates prioritize their skills for work independently and in groups, especially during stressful academic periods. (Natividad et al., 2024) found that BSBA-Marketing Management graduates are highly employable due to their communication, critical thinking, and information technology skills. (Estrellado et al., 2025)found that practical exposure and strong industry linkages contributed to smoother job transitions and employability. (Ocampo, 2025) reported that aligning academic preparation with market requirements improved employment outcomes for Business Administration graduates from 2018 to 2022.

According to (Llanes et al., 2022) highlighted, BSBA-HRDMs had a higher attendance rate at more job fairs, seminars, and good industry linkages. Moreover, (Castro et al., 2025) highlighted the importance of responsibility, time management, adaptability, and productivity in the eyes of employers, which once again supports the idea that the well-roundedness of preparation can be highly important in future careers.

Role Model Influence

According to (Aloamaka et al., 2020) he revealed that role models influence entrepreneurial intentions through attitude, perception of behavioral control, and social norms. Similarly, (Roslan et al., 2020) established that a higher learning environment and role models have positive relations with the entrepreneurial intentions of TVET students. These results show that role model influence is psychologically motivational and structural in influencing program enrollment and career aspirations.

(Bagia et al., 2023), he found that role models have both a direct and an indirect influence on the entrepreneurial intentions, and the connection between them is mediated by self-belief and normative expectations. Added by (Alcontin et al., 2024), this argument is added by demonstrating that the personal and environmental contexts, especially perceptions of

professional roles and self-efficacy, strongly predict students seeking librarianship as a profession. Simultaneously, (Liputra et al., 2025) revealed entrepreneurial passion, usually triggered by role models, as an important predictor of entrepreneurial intention. According to these studies, the role model influence is multifaceted, improving self-assessment and motivation to pursue higher education.

The role model influence mechanism is influenced by perceived similarity between students and their role models. (Allen & Collisson, 2020) studies show that minority students are more likely to make similar academic decisions when exposed to role models of the same ethnicity. The image of an academic department also plays a crucial role in students' decisions when deciding majors in business administration. Entrepreneurial role model influencers, who combine traditional mentoring and social media visibility, are seen as potent sources of entrepreneurial intentions. These findings underscore the importance of relatable and visible role models in student enrollment decisions (Ahmad et al., 2021).

Other Influencing Factors

It is also essential to establish the factors that drive enrollment and understand why students prefer business administration courses. Research indicates that the key factors determining institutional choice include academic reputation, scholarship, financial aid, marketing and promotions, micro-credential, industry partnership, and specialization track. These factors determine quality, cost, and feasibility perceptions essential to enrollment performance. This is the context in which this review places these factors, with respect to Saint Michael College of Caraga, to understand how these factors influence the decisions made by students in business administration programs.

Academic Reputation

A college's reputation is among the main factors that affect student enrollment in a college, together with the quality of the program and other external support systems. They discovered that the institutional reputation is a significant factor in the student selection within the Philippine environment (Gambulao & Depayso, 2023), and the view of quality and credibility spurs the enrollment. Broadly speaking, (Amoozegar et al., 2025) validated that a good institutional reputation boosts the appeal of a university to students, and applicants identify reputable names with quality education, access to facilities, and career opportunities. This research confirm that reputation is a determining factor in defining enrollment trends.

The virtual world has made reputation even more significant in the enrollment choice. Investigations by (Ghani et al., 2023) revealed that the level of enrollment was higher in universities with a good online presence and digital reputation, showing how reputation has been relocated to the virtual world. Regularly, (Amado Mateus & Juarez Acosta, 2022) noted that the perception of quality and attractiveness in academic achievements and student success stories enhanced online communication of the institutional achievements. The combination of these results can imply that academic reputation, established with the help of traditional indicators and online tools, is important in guiding students to choose higher education institutions.

Scholarship and Financial Aid

Studies show that financial aid greatly influences student performance at learning institutions and the trends of institutional enrollment. Financial aid programs sponsored by the government are generous in that they cover tuition fees and other living costs, encouraging students to perform better academically and be more motivated to continue school (Gabat-Lopez et al., 2024). (Tohiroh et al., 2025) revealed that scholarship programs like the KIP Lecture Scholarship have also positively impacted learning motivation and academic performance

regarding Grade Point Average improvement. From an institutional point of view, financial support mechanisms serve as powerful enrollment motivators in addition to the marketing propositions like academic reputation and location of the institution, where research has found good positive correlations among enrollment motivators and marketing propositions (Enguito, 2025).

The impact of scholarship programs in different contexts has been demonstrated to affect student performance and engagement positively. (Jayson et al., 2018)have studied a scholarship program of a private institution in the Philippines and discovered that even though the program had a limited budget, it increased the participation rates of students of various socio-economic backgrounds, which resulted in changes to the institutional policy, following the recommendations of the stakeholders. (Arfan & Arifin Renaldo, 2024) found that scholarship students at Caltex Riau Polytechnic had substantial academic performance improvement, demonstrating more effort after tuition fees were cut. These results demonstrate that scholarships enhance institutional sustainability and enhance student performance.

Marketing And Promotion

Higher education marketing and promotion are very diverse in digital, online, and conventional marketing, which determine how students choose where to study. Digital marketing has gained particular importance, and a study indicates strong relationships between digital marketing campaigns and admission to business administration programs (Rajasekar & Aithal, 2022). Social media exposure, ad retargeting, mobile-accessible websites, and university webinars are tactics that have been demonstrated to impact students' decisions directly (Labausa et al., 2023). There are a high awareness and visibility created by social media, especially Facebook, and an increase in the number of enrollments is a good testimony of its effectiveness.

Online marketing also reinforces this power by making the institutions more accessible and attractive to potential students. Equally, (Wijaya et al., 2023) discovered that search engines like Google AdWords, social media advertisements, and online ads are important initiatives that boost registration intention, particularly among Generation Z students in the Indonesian private universities. (Cabeliza, 2021)(Syunita & Tikno, 2025) further confirmed that social media engagement and personalized direct messaging are effective in influencing enrollment decisions, with social media engagement exerting the greatest impact. In addition, (Labausa et al., 2023)identified university webinar platforms as the most influential tools for enrollment, while social media presence, mobile-friendly websites, and educational applications also contribute to raising awareness of academic programs and services, thereby strengthening enrollment outcomes.

According to Wijaya et al., 2023, digital benefits in radio broadcasting include unlimited choice, improved sound quality, global accessibility, advertising control, economic value, data-driven insights, and capabilities that allow advertisers to connect to radio satellites quickly and effectively, engaging the target audience. The paper emphasizes radio as a low-cost tool for experiential learning in college advertising programs, recommending its inclusion to teach sustainable marketing practices, especially in regions with limited digital access. It demonstrates radio's enduring value for targeted campaigns, urging marketers to integrate it with digital tools for hybrid strategies. Emphasizes radio's synergy in marketing, advocating for its use in building emotional connections amid digital noise (Cabeliza, 2021)illustrates radio's adaptation to streaming trends, recommending it for narrative-driven campaigns in contemporary marketing.

According to (Bohara et al., 2022), research indicates face-to-face advocacy shifts opinions by 20% more than mass media, through personalized narratives. Demonstrates its efficacy in targeted persuasion, suggesting integration into advocacy strategies for issue-based campaigns.

Surveys of lobbyists reveal that in-person meetings yield 30% higher policy influence than virtual ones, via relationship cultivation. Emphasizes face-to-face interactions for nuanced persuasion, advocating for hybrid models in professional advocacy. Analyzing protest data, the paper shows face-to-face advocacy boosts participant recruitment by 25% through emotional appeals and reciprocity. Highlights its superiority in mobilizing support, positioning it as essential for movement-building in an era of online activism (J. Lee et al., 2022).

According to (Bartoloni & Ancillai, 2024), social media has been around for 20 years and has profoundly affected the dynamics of interactions between companies and customers. Studies have increasingly focused on how firms effectively use social media in their marketing strategies. Social media platforms empower marketers to potentially connect with billions of customers, enhance visibility, and create positive word-of-mouth. Even today, social media remains a pervasive influence on various aspects of users' lives and behaviors across all stages of customers' journey, thus impacting customers' relationships with organizations and brands.

Micro-Credential

Recent studies (2021–2025) highlight that micro-credentials significantly influence student decisions to enroll in Business Administration programs due to their perceived impact on employability, career advancement, and skill relevance. Research by LaPlante (2024) shows that MBA students view micro-credentials as tools for "futureproofing" careers, enhancing résumés, and gaining a competitive advantage in the job market. Similarly, Ngoc Ha et al. (2025) found that both employers and students value micro-credentials for developing employability skills, with students especially motivated by how these credentials strengthen their CVs and personal identity capital. These findings show that programs offering flexible, skill-focused micro-credentials attract more students who prioritize practical competencies and improved career outcomes.

Several studies emphasize that business schools adopting micro-credentials gain an edge in enrollment because these offerings respond directly to industry skill demands. Research by Gamage & Dehideniya (2025) and Narayanaswamy et al. (2024) shows that micro-credentials bridge gaps between traditional education and evolving industry needs by validating up-to-date technical and soft skills. Systematic reviews by Varadarajan et al. (2023) and Ahsan et al. (2023) also reveal that higher education institutions are increasingly integrating micro-credentials into degree structures to stay competitive, enhance program appeal, and support institutional innovation. This alignment between business schools and employers reinforces the value of business programs, making them more attractive to prospective students seeking programs that lead to clearer, more marketable outcomes.

Literature from 2021–2025 also identifies challenges that influence how effectively micro-credentials drive enrollment. Studies from Mauritius (Santally, 2024) and other developing contexts highlight issues such as low awareness, unclear credential recognition, and the need for structured pathways that connect micro-credentials to formal qualifications. Peters (2023) emphasizes that institutional leadership and strategic planning are essential for integrating micro-credentials in ways that genuinely boost enrollment and academic value. Meanwhile, Orman (2023) and Maina et al. (2022) note the importance of credibility, competency-based assessment, and collaboration between universities and industry. Overall, the literature suggests that while micro-credentials strongly appeal to business students, their full potential as enrollment drivers depends on strategic implementation, stakeholder awareness, and clear pathways to career advancement.

Industry Partnership

Industry–Academe Partnerships (IAPs) are increasingly recognized as strategic mechanisms that enhance the relevance, quality, and employability outcomes of higher education

programs. For Business Administration programs, partnerships with local and national industries provide students with practical experiences, internships, and career pathways, which in turn influence enrollment decisions. Research shows that students often consider institutional partnerships with industry as a key factor when selecting a business program, alongside curriculum quality, reputation, and employability prospects (Bernarte, 2014; De Guman, 2020; Medado, 2018; Janoras, 2024).

Bernarte (2014) examined how Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) in the Philippines engage in industry partnerships, including internships, on-the-job training, and research collaboration. The study highlighted that such partnerships provide practical training, enhance employability, and increase the attractiveness of Business Administration programs. By bridging the gap between theoretical education and industry demands, partnerships offer students both exposure and opportunities for skill development, which can be an influential factor in program selection.

De Guman (2020) conducted an empirical study on BSBA students and found that when internship programs with industry partners are effectively implemented, students reported significant improvements in communication, teamwork, people management, and work ethics. The study suggests that strong industry linkages enhance the perceived value of a Business Administration program, as students gain real-world skills and confidence in their employability.

Medado (2018), through a qualitative multiple-case study of several HEIs in Metro Manila, explored the factors that drive the formation of industry–academe partnerships. The study revealed that internal strategic goals, such as aligning curriculum with industry needs and improving employability, as well as external pressures from labor market demands, influence how partnerships are formed. These findings suggest that institutions like Saint Michael College of

Caraga (SMCC) may strategically develop partnerships to increase competitiveness and attract more students to their Business Administration programs.

Janoras (2024) examined whether the curriculum in financial management matches industry needs by surveying graduates and employers. The study showed that when academic programs align with industry requirements, graduates and employers perceive the skills and knowledge gained as highly relevant. This alignment, often facilitated through partnerships, enhances the perceived value of the program and can positively influence enrollment decisions, particularly among students who prioritize employability and career readiness.

Specialization Track

Business Administration programs in many colleges and universities offer several specializations that help students prepare for their chosen career paths. Schools such as De La Salle University Dasmariñas highlight that majors like Financial Management, Human Resource Management, Operations Management, Business Economics, and Marketing Management are designed to develop practical skills and professional readiness (DLSU D, n.d.). Having different specializations available gives students the freedom to choose the field that best matches their interests, strengths, and career goals. This means that specialization options can influence a student's decision to enroll in a particular school because students may select an institution on the basis of the specific majors it offers rather than only the general BSBA program. For Saint Michael College of Caraga, understanding how each specialization affects students' enrollment decisions is important in identifying which academic factors attract prospective students to the program.

Studies on the Financial Management specialization show that students often choose this track because of its strong connection to employability. A tracer study by Pumihic and Binwag (2024) on graduates of the BSBA Financial Management program at Ifugao State University

reported an employability rate of 74.2 percent. The graduates attributed their job readiness to a curriculum that reflected real industry needs, effective teaching strategies, and available school facilities. Although many graduates started in clerical or contractual positions, the study emphasized that skills in financial analysis, digital tools, and entrepreneurship supported their career development. These findings suggest that the Financial Management specialization attracts students who are concerned about employment opportunities and industry relevance. This pattern is likely to influence enrollment at Saint Michael College of Caraga, especially among students who value financial careers and job stability.

Students who choose Human Resource Management as their major are usually influenced by a combination of personal ability and practical considerations. Uzair (2024) found that financial capacity, self assessment, available career opportunities, and individual personality traits all play a significant role in students' decision to select HRM. The study also showed that social influences, such as family members or peers, can shape students' preferences. These results are consistent with global findings which state that students tend to select a specialization that fits their strengths and provides good employment prospects. At Saint Michael College of Caraga, the HRM major may appeal to students who enjoy working with people, communicating, and managing workplace dynamics. This means HRM can function as an enrollment driver, especially for students who envision themselves in roles related to personnel management or organizational development.

Operations Management specialization is often chosen based on the way the course content is delivered. Hoefle et al., (2020) found that traditional OM courses were sometimes viewed as difficult and disconnected from real life business applications. However, when the course was redesigned to include experiential learning, practical activities, and integrated business concepts, students showed greater interest and engagement. This suggests that teaching strategies and course relevance have a direct effect on students' preference for OM. For Saint

Michael College of Caraga, ensuring that Operations Management subjects are applied and hands on may increase student interest in this specialization. When students see how OM concepts work in actual business settings, they are more likely to consider it as a preferred major.

Career expectations and economic value are important factors in choosing Business Economics as a major. Nguyen et al., (2023) found that students' decisions were influenced by their personal interest, their expectations for job opportunities, financial capacity, and the opinions of influential people around them. Students saw the Economics major as a way to gain analytical and research related skills that could help them secure stable and meaningful careers. These findings indicate that Business Economics attracts students who are analytical and career oriented. In the context of Saint Michael College of Caraga, this specialization may appeal to students who want to pursue careers in economic planning, financial analysis, or research based roles. As a result, BE functions as another possible driver of enrollment for students who prefer data oriented or policy related career paths.

Marketing Management is often chosen by students who are motivated by creativity, communication, and flexible career options. Omar, Nazri, and Yazid (2016) found that intrinsic motivation, wide career opportunities, and positive experiences in introductory marketing courses were major factors influencing students to choose Marketing as their major. Students viewed marketing as dynamic and appealing because of the variety of roles available in advertising, branding, digital marketing, and market research. For Saint Michael College of Caraga, providing engaging introductory courses and showcasing real marketing career paths can encourage more students to consider Marketing Management. This specialization tends to attract individuals who enjoy interacting with people, creating ideas, and exploring modern marketing practices.

Enrollment in Business Administration Programs

The reputation of the institution and the outcomes of graduates are vital determinants in enrolling in Business Administration programs. Tracer studies by (Abella et al., 2022) and (Natividad et al., 2024) confirmed that credibility of the programs in question and employability opportunities are the factors that encourage students to enroll in business programs because the successful experiences of the graduates will strengthen institutional popularity. On the same emphasis, (Castro et al., 2025) also emphasized that employer responses regarding BSBA graduates are a reminder of the importance of ensuring that the outcome of the curricular activities is relevant to the industry's expectations, making programs even more appealing. This position was upheld by (Lamichhane et al., 2022), who indicated that both tourism students and future opportunities affect the choice of career of BA students. All these studies verify that the academic reputation and perceived return on investment are important forces behind the enrollment of students into Business Administration programs.

The study by (Ventolero, 2021) has shown that enrollment in BSBA in the Philippines is primarily affected by the accessibility of campuses and accessible resources. (Sahu & Kumar, 2023) have developed this by showing that management students consider several things during school selection, including placement opportunities, facilities, and the image of the institutions. These results underscore the role played by physical and geographical characteristics of institutions of higher learning in influencing the decision taken by higher education students (towards opting to enroll in the institution), especially in competitive courses such as Business Administration.

The reviewed studies show that many factors influence students' decisions to enroll in Business Administration programs. These include marketing strategies, school qualities, and

personal circumstances. Research from different countries shows that promotions like social media ads, online campaigns, and word-of-mouth can strongly affect a student's choice (Olumeru et al., 2024; Sikalumbi et al., 2023). Aside from marketing, factors such as the school's reputation, program quality, support services, and facilities also help attract students (Sokoya, 2021; Toussaint et al., 2025). Parents, friends, and role models also play a big part in guiding and motivating students in their program choices (Aloamaka et al., 2020; Mickler Jr., 2021). In addition, age, gender, year level, and family income can affect a student's readiness and opportunity to continue studying (Enciso & De Sesto, 2025). These factors work together and show that both personal and school-related reasons influence student enrollment.

Studies also show that scholarships, financial aid, and the hope for a successful future are major reasons why students choose Business Administration programs. Financial help encourages students to study harder and makes college more affordable for everyone (Gabat-Lopez et al., 2024). Students also choose these programs because they believe business degrees can lead to better job opportunities and career growth (Caliat et al., 2023; Natividad et al., 2024). Location and accessibility of the school, as well as online visibility through marketing, also make a big difference in students' choices (Labausa et al., 2023; Triyono et al., 2021). Overall, these studies show that students' decisions to take Business Administration are shaped by school reputation, social influence, financial conditions, and career expectations, helping explain the enrollment patterns at Saint Michael College of Caraga.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

Social Cognitive Theory

According to the Social Cognitive Theory developed by (Bandura, 1986), behavior is developed independently when individual beliefs, environmental factors, and behavior patterns interact continuously. Parental influence and peer influence, role model influence, are some of the factors of social learning, which, in the context of student enrollment, influence the self-efficacy and future success influence among students. (Bandura & by Zumeri, 1997) emphasized self-efficacy, the confidence in executing specific tasks, as an important factor in decision-making and persistence during academic activities. Value and aspirations are also passed on by peers and role models who influence the individual. The effect of seeing competent peers or mentors, as (Schunk & DiBenedetto, 2020) observed, boosts the level of confidence and motivation of learners. Therefore, when parents are supportive, peers show that they have achieved in academics, and role models demonstrate that they can work in each career, students have assurance and optimism of having a degree in business administration.

Push-Pull Factor Theory

The Push–Pull Factor Theory by Lee (1966) explains that students make enrollment decisions based on pressures that push them away from less desirable options and attractions that pull them toward more favorable choices. Push factors include negative or limiting conditions such as poor job opportunities, financial restrictions, or dissatisfaction with other educational programs. Pull factors, meanwhile, consist of positive institutional attributes like academic reputation, career opportunities, scholarships, and a supportive learning environment. Prior research confirms that students react to both push and pull influences when choosing a school or program (Maringe & Gibbs, 2008; Wickneswary et al., 2024). At Saint Michael College of Caraga, regional economic limitations and fewer higher-education options may act as push factors for

students. In contrast, institutional features function as strong pull factors, such as the presence of micro-credentials, which enhance employability by offering short, industry-aligned skills training, and industry partnership that provide internships, real-world exposure, and higher confidence in job placement . Additionally, the availability of specialization tracks that match students' interests, SHS strand, and career goals further draws them toward the BSBA program (Nguyen et al., 2023; European Commission, 2022). Together, these factors help explain how SMCC's academic offerings attract students and shape their enrollment decision.

The combination of these viewpoints makes the theoretical framework capture the psychological and contextual aspects of the enrollment choices. The Social Cognitive Theory is a theory that describes the process of developing beliefs, motivations, and aspirations that form a student's choice with the influence of parents, peers, and role models (Bandura & by Zumeri, 1997; Schunk & DiBenedetto, 2020). This is supplemented by the Push-Pull Factor Theory, which emphasizes the interactions of external conditions and institutional characteristics into the final choice, considering their disadvantages and opportunities (E. S. Lee, 1966; Wickneswary et al., 2024). These theories form a solid base for analyzing the quantitative relationship of personal, social, and environmental factors affecting the enrollment of business administration students.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

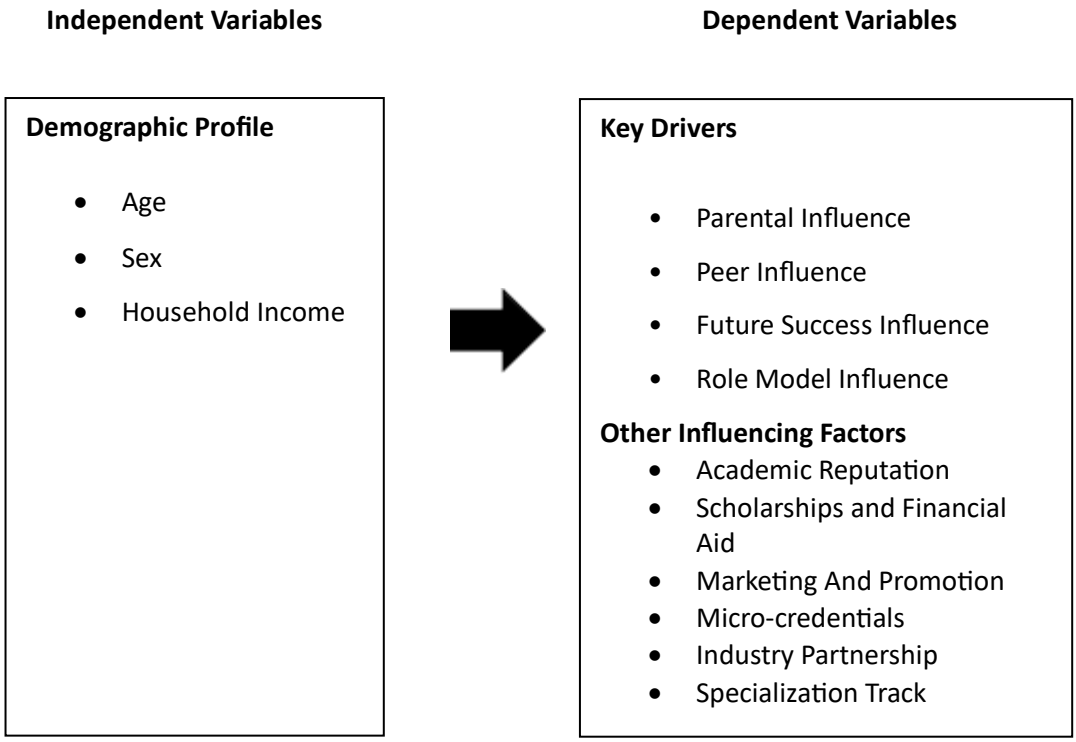


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the key drivers of enrollment in Business Administration Program at Saint Michael College of Caraga. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of:

    1.1 age;

    1.2 sex; and

    1.3 household income?

2. To what extent are key drivers of enrollment in the Business Administration Program in terms of:

    2.1 parental influence;

    2.2 peer influence;

    2.3 future success influence; and

    2.4 role model influence?

3. What are the other influencing factors of enrollment in the Business Administration Programs in terms of:

    3.1 academic reputation;

    3.2 scholarships and financial aid;

    3.3 marketing and promotion;

    3.4 micro-credentials;

    3.5 industry partnership; and

    3.6 specialization track?

4. Is there a significant relationship between demographic profile and identified drivers to other influencing factors of the students enrolled in business administration program?

5. Is there a significant relationship between identified drivers and other influencing factors of the students enrolled in business administration program?

1.6 Hypothesis

The hypothesis guided the study and tested at $\alpha = 0.05$ level of significance.

H_0: There is no significant relationship between demographic profile and identified drivers of the students enrolled in Business Administration program.

H_1: There is a significant relationship between demographic profile and identified drivers of the students enrolled in Business Administration program.

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study will focus on identifying the key drivers that influence student enrollment in the Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) program under the College of Business and Management (CBM) of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

The scope of this study will be limited only to BSBA students from first year to fourth year who are officially enrolled under the CBM. It will not include students from other programs within SMCC or from other institutions. The primary data will be gathered through an adapted and modified questionnaire. Therefore, the findings of this study will be confined to providing insights on the specific factors influencing the enrollment decisions of BSBA students within the particular context of the College of Business and Management of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

1.8 Definition of Terms

For a better understanding and classification, the following terms and words are operationally defined as follows:

Academic Reputation. The perceived quality and credibility of the Business Administration program and Saint Michael College of Caraga as evaluated by students and stakeholders.

Age. The number of years a student has lived since birth.

Future Success Influence. The student's perception that enrolling in the BSBA program will enhance career opportunities, professional growth, and long-term life success.

Household Income. The total combined income of all earning members of a student's household, used to assess the family's economic capacity to support education.

Industry Partnership. Collaborative agreements or projects between SMCC's BSBA program and external companies or organizations that provide internships, training, mentorship, or employment opportunities for students.

Key Drivers of Enrollment. Factors that motivate or influence students to choose and enroll in the BSBA program at SMCC.

Marketing and Promotion. The strategies and activities employed by SMCC to attract prospective students, including advertising, social media campaigns, outreach programs, and informational events.

Micro-credential. A short, focused program or certification offered within the BSBA curriculum that develops specific skills or competencies recognized by industry.

Parental Influence. The effect of parental guidance, support, expectations, or advice on a student's decision to enroll in the BSBA program.

Peer Influence. The impact of classmates, friends, or social groups on a student's enrollment decisions.

Role Model Influence. The effect of admired individuals, such as teachers, professionals, or public figures, on a student's choice of the BSBA program.

Scholarship and Financial Aid. Financial support, grants, or tuition assistance offered by SMCC to reduce the cost of education and encourage student enrollment.

Sex. The biological or self-identified sex of the student, such as male or female.

Specialization Track. A focused area or concentration within the BSBA program (e.g., Marketing Management, Financial Management) that allows students to develop expertise in a specific field of business.

CHAPTER II

METHODOLOGY

This chapter will present the research design, locale, respondents, instrument, ethical standards, data-gathering procedures, data analysis plan and procedure that will be used in the study. It will also describe the materials and instruments to be employed and explain how the researchers will collect and analyze the data.

2.1 Research Design

The research design that will be used in this study is a quantitative descriptive-correlational research design. The descriptive element will be employed to present the demographic profile of the respondents and the level of the identified enrollment drivers. The correlational component will determine the relationship between the key drivers—parental influence, peer influence, future success influence, role model influence, and other influencing factors: academic reputation; school facilities; location and accessibility; scholarship and financial aid; and marketing and promotion—and the students' decision to enroll in the Business Administration program.

Furthermore, a predictive analysis will be conducted to identify which among these drivers will serve as the strongest predictor of enrollment in the program. This design will be considered suitable because it will allow the study to measure, describe, and analyze data objectively through statistical analysis at a 0.05 significance level.

2.2 Research Locale

Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) is located in Barangay 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines. SMCC is a privately run Catholic education institution covering a wide range of academic courses such as Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) through the College of Business and Management (CBM).

Business Administration program is currently applying for Level II accreditation from the Philippine Association of Colleges and Universities Commission on Accreditation (PACUCOA, n.d.). CBM department ensures that graduates from the Financial Management, Marketing Management, Human Resource Management, Operation Management, and Basic Economics programs (PACUCOA), obtain relevant micro-credentials, such as the Certified Financial Management Professional Accreditation (CFMPA), Certified Financial Management Specialist (CFMS), Certified Marketing Management Specialist (CMMS) , Certified Human Resource Associate (CHRA), Certified Operations Management Specialist (COMS), and Certified Business Economist (CBE). This study will be conducted to collect data from currently enrolled BSBA students, ensuring that the findings accurately represent their enrollment patterns and motivational factors within the institution.

2.3 Research Respondents

Table 1. Respondents of the study

Program	Year Level	Population	Frequency	Percentage
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Financial Management	1st Year	63	34	18.7%
	2nd Year	40	22	12.1%
	3rd Year	48	26	14.3%
	4th year	50	27	14.8%
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Marketing Management	1st Year	24	13	7.1%
	2nd Year	21	11	6.0%
	3rd Year	12	7	3.8%
	4th Year	16	9	4.9%
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Human Resource Management	1st Year	14	8	4.4%
	2nd Year	3	2	1.1%
	3rd Year	9	5	2.7%
	4th Year	13	7	3.8%
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Business Economics	1st Year	4	2	1.1%
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Operations Management	1st Year	16	9	4.9%
TOTAL		**333**	**182**	**100%**

This table shows the number of students enrolled in the Business Administration programs. A total of 182 students enrolled in the BSBA programs at SMCC for the Academic Year 2025-2026 will serve as the participants of the study. The respondents will be chosen based on the firsthand experience and knowledge of the factors that affected their choice to pursue the BSBA program. The data collected will reflect the accurate perceptions and motivations of the students across the College of Business and Management.

To guarantee that all the year levels (1st year—4th year) will be observed in the sample, the researchers will use a stratified random sampling method to ensure that all the year levels will be proportionally represented. The sampling technique will provide a balanced sample of

respondents and will increase validity of the findings. Information will be collected using a structured survey questionnaire that will aim to measure different enrollment drivers including parental influence, peer influence, future success influence, role model influence, and other influences like academic reputation, scholarship and financial aid, marketing and promotion, micro-credentials, industry partnership, and specialization track.

2.4 Research Instrument

The survey questionnaire that will be used in this study will be researcher-made, designed specifically to address the objectives of this study and capture the key drivers influencing student enrollment in the BSBA program at Saint Michael College of Caraga. The instrument will include items that are tailored to the context of SMCC and the specific variables under investigation.

To ensure the instrument's accuracy and consistency, it will undergo both reliability and validity testing. The content validity of the questionnaire will be evaluated by a panel of experts. Meanwhile, pilot testing will be conducted among 15 random college students at Saint Michael College of Caraga, who will not be included as respondents in the main survey. The results of the pilot test will be used to assess and improve the clarity, reliability, and appropriateness of the instrument before its final implementation.

The questionnaire will be divided into two parts:

- **Part I:** presents the demographic profile of the respondents, including age, sex, and household income; and
- **Part II:** consists of items measuring the degree of influence. parental, peer, role model, and future success drivers, as well as other variables such as academic reputation,

scholarship and financial aid, marketing and promotion, micro-credentials, industry partnership, and specialization track.

A. Key Drivers of Enrollment in Business Administration Program.

B. Other Influencing Factors of Business Administration Program.

The researcher will use descriptive statistics to analyze the data gathered, and the mean will be used as primary statistical tool. In this study, the researcher will summarize and describe the key drivers influencing student enrollment in the Business Administration program.

The statement will be interpreted using the Likert scale. It will use a 4-point rating scale, where a score of 4 “Strongly Agree” will correspond to a mean range of 3.25 to 4.00, indicating a high level of agreement. A score of 3 “Agree” will fall between 2.50 and 3.24, reflecting moderate agreement. A score of 2 “Disagree” will correspond to a mean range of 1.75 to 2.49, suggesting low agreement. Lastly, a score of 1 “Strongly Disagree” will be associated with a mean range of 1.00 to 1.74, signifying a very low level of agreement. This scale will be used to evaluate the strength of respondents’ perceptions regarding the key factors influencing their enrollment decisions.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) Protection

In this study, no new products, technologies, or symbols of any kind needed to be patented or trademarked. Each secondary source will be properly referenced, and copyrighted works will be utilized only as an academic requirement. The intellectual property rights will be safeguard by ensuring originality and due credit to third-party content.

B. Informed Consent

The study's objectives, procedures, and benefits will be presented to the respondents as an information sheet. Before answering the questionnaire, written consent will be obtained to ascertain the respondents' voluntary nature in answering the survey. In the case of individuals who will be below 18 years of age, their parents or guardians will be contacted. The consent form will be composed in simple and straightforward language to ensure complete understanding

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

To ensure confidentiality, the answers will be coded and depersonalized. The data will be safely stored, and only the researcher accessed them. The reported results will be presented in aggregate form; thus, it will be impossible to trace individual responses from the participants.

D. Voluntary Participation

The study will be conducted on a completely voluntary basis. Respondents will be informed that they have the right to withdraw at any point without penalty. This will guarantee their freedom and will provide a dignified atmosphere to every participant.

E. Minimization of Harm

The study will not subject the participants to physical, emotional, or psychological injury. The questions in the survey will be carefully designed to avoid sensitive or offensive content. Participants will be provided with access to support mechanisms, such as school counseling services, in case any discomfort will arise.

F. Beneficence

Even though direct benefits might not be given to the participants, their responses will provide valuable insights into the factors that drive students to pursue Business Administration. These findings will be used to improve institutional policies and practices at Saint Michael College of Caraga. A summary of the results will be made available to respondents upon request.

G. Justice and Equitable Participant Recruitment

The respondents will be selected according to clear inclusion criteria that will encompass all first year to fourth year students of Business Administration. They will be chosen without prejudice based on gender, age, and socioeconomic status to promote fairness and representation.

H. Data Accuracy and Data Integrity

Data collection and analysis will be conducted objectively using standardized tools and procedures. The questionnaire will be tested for reliability, and the results will be reviewed for consistency. It will be ensured that there will be no data manipulation or falsification.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The authors of the study will describe the research results accurately without distorting the data. The limitations will be acknowledged, and all the sources of information will be properly cited. The research process and results will not be influenced by any conflict of interest.

J. Copyrighted Materials

All copyrighted academic materials and references will be properly cited. The conduct of the study will not violate copyright laws or academic ethics, as full credit will be given to the original authors.

K. Human Subjects Considerations

The security and dignity of the human respondents will be prioritized. Informed consent, voluntary involvement, and confidentiality will be strictly observed in accordance with institutional and international ethical standards for research involving human subjects.

L. Conscientious AI and Digital Usage

The researcher will be assisted by digital tools such as ChatGPT for idea generation and writing guidance, Grammarly for grammar and clarity enhancement, and QuillBot for rewording and refinement. The application of these tools will be responsibly, and all outputs will be critically

evaluated to ensure accuracy, originality, and ethical compliance. The only assistance to be utilized from AI tools will serve as writing aids and will not replace human judgement.

M. Ethical Approval

The Saint Michael College of Caraga Institutional Review Board will grant ethical approval, ensuring compliance with the highest standards for respondents' safety, data confidentiality, and intellectual property.

N. Disposal

The researcher will obtain ethical clearance from the Ethics Committee as well as the Research and Instructional Innovation Department (RIID) of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedure

This section describes the steps followed by the researchers in collecting, organizing, and analyzing the data needed for the study.

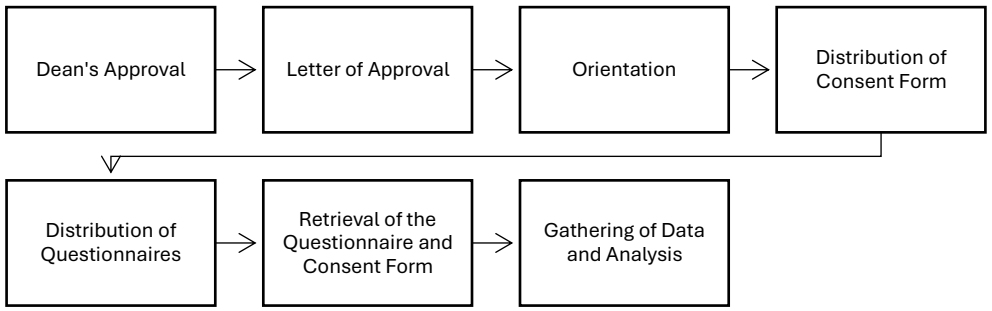


Figure 2. Shows the flow of the data gathering procedures.

Dean's approval. The researchers will request permission from the School Registrar Office to obtain the total number of Business Administration Students enrolled at Saint Michael College of Caraga as of October 2025.

Letter of Approval. The researchers submitted a letter of request to the Head of the School Registrar Office to validate the study and gain permission to proceed.

Orientation. The researchers will conduct an orientation for the identified respondents of Business Administration students to inform them about the purpose of the study and ensure they understand the ethical considerations involved.

Distribution of Informed Consent Form. The researchers will distribute informed consent forms to the respondents, which will serve as agreements confirming that they understand their rights and have the freedom to agree or decline participation in the study.

Distribution of Questionnaires. The researchers will personally distribute the survey questionnaires to the identified respondents. The respondents will be given sample time to provide necessary information for the study.

Retrieval of the Questionnaire and Consent Form. After the allotted time, the researchers will personally retrieve the completed questionnaires and consent forms to prepare the data for analysis.

Gathering of Data and Analysis. The data will be collected, checked for completeness, tallied, presented, analyzed, and interpreted using appropriate statistical techniques and tools to identify the "Key Drivers of Enrollment in Business Administration Programs: The Case of Saint Michael College of Caraga".

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

Statistical Treatment

The data that will be gathered from the survey questionnaires will be collected, organized, tabulated, and analyzed using the following statistical tools:

Frequency and Percentage. This tool will be used to determine the demographic profile of the respondents.

Weighted Mean. This tool will be used to determine the level of influence of key drivers such as parental influence, peer influence, future success influence, role model influence, and other

influencing factors including academic reputation, school facilities, location and accessibility, scholarship and financial aid, and marketing and promotion on students' enrollment decisions in the Business Administration programs.

Spearman Rho Correlation. This statistical tool will be used to determine the significant relationship between the key drivers of enrollment and the students' decision to enroll in the Business Administration programs of Saint Michael College of Caraga. This test will be appropriate since the variables to be measured are ordinal in nature.

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College of Business and Management

Research Questionnaire

Name (Optional): _____

Address (Optional): _____

Part 1: Respondent's Profile

Instructions:

Please answer this questionnaire properly and sincerely by putting a check mark (/) in the space that best corresponds to your observation on the following items using the following criteria:

Age

☐ 18-20 Years Old

☐ 21-23 Years Old

☐ 24 Years Old and Above

Sex

☐ Male

☐ Female

Household Income Per Month

☐ Below- P10,000

☐ P10,001- P20,000

☐ P20,001- P30,000

☐ P30,000 - Above

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Part II: A Study on the Drivers of Students' Choice in Enrolling in the Business Administration Programs.

General Instructions:

Please check the statement using the scale provided that best describes how much each factor influenced your decision to enroll in the **Business Administration programs** of **Saint Michael College of Caraga.** We encourage you to answer honestly, as the accuracy of this study depends on your responses.

Rating Scale	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
4	Strongly Agree (SA)	The statement is highly influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.
3	Agree (A)	The statement moderately influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.
2	Disagree (D)	The statement slightly influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.
1	Strongly Disagree (SD)	The statement did not influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.

A. Key Drivers of Enrollment in Business Administration Program

a. Parental Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. My parents encouraged me to take the BSBA program.				
2. My parents believe Business Administration offers good career opportunities				
3. My parents' educational background influenced my course decision.				
4. My parents' approval was important in choosing my program.				
5. My parents helped me select a program aligned with my strengths and interests.				

b. Peers Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. My friends encouraged me to enroll in the BSBA program.				
2. I was influenced by classmates who also chose Business Administration.				
3. I tend to choose programs recommended by my closest peers.				
4. Seeing my peers succeed academically motivated me to choose this program.				
5. My peer group helped shape my perception of the BSBA program.				

c. Future Success Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. The BSBA program provides many employment opportunities after graduation.				
2. I believe the BSBA degree will help me achieve my long-term career goals.				
3. The skills taught in this program are valuable in the job market.				
4. I chose BSBA because it is aligned with my desired profession.				
5. I believe that pursuing BSBA will help me gain financial stability in the future.				

d. Role Model Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. I was influenced by a person I admire who is successful in the field of business.				
2. My teachers and mentors encouraged me to consider the BSBA program.				
3. Seeing professionals in business careers inspired me to take BSBA.				
4. I follow business-related influencers or personalities whose careers I want to emulate.				
5. My role models made me feel confident about taking a business-related course.				

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B. Other Influencing Factors of Business Administration Program

a. Academic Reputation	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. SMCC has a good reputation in offering business programs.				
2. The BSBA program is known for having competent instructors.				
3. The program is recognized by students for its quality curriculum.				
4. The reputation of SMCC influenced my decision to enroll.				
b. Scholarship and Financial Aid				
1. The availability of scholarships influenced my decision to study at SMCC.				
2. Financial aid programs make the BSBA program more accessible.				
3. I enrolled because the program is financially manageable for my family.				
4. Discounts or grants offered by the school encouraged me to continue BSBA.				
c. Marketing and Promotion				
1. Social media postings about SMCC influenced my decision to enroll.				
2. Advertisements or online promotion helped me learn about the program.				
3. The school's promotional strategies increased my interest in the BSBA program.				
4. Radio advertisements about SMCC influenced my decision to enroll in the BSBA program.				
d. Micro-credentials				
1. Micro-credential programs offered by SMCC attracted me to the BSBA program.				
2. Certifications such as CFMPA, CMMS, CHRA, and others influenced my decision.				
3. I believe micro-credentials can improve my employability.				

4. I value the extra training and skill development the program provides.				
e. Industry Partnership				
1. Strong partnerships with companies influenced my choice of program.				
2. Internship opportunities offered by SMCC motivated me to take BSBA.				
3. I believe industry collaborations improve practical learning.				
4. The possibility of employment linkages encouraged me to enroll.				
f. Specialization Track				
1. The availability of different BSBA majors influenced my decision.				
2. I chose to enroll because I am interested in the specialization offered.				
3. The specialization I chose matches my career goals.				
4. The specialization tracks in BSBA made the program more appealing.				

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CURRICULUM VITAE



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Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Logistics Officer**

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Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Member**

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Secondary	:	Nasipit National Vocational School
Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC College of Business and Management - Local Student Government	**Marketing Management Representative**
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Marketing Management - 3 Mayor**

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Secondary	:	Vinapor National High School
Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Member**

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Educational Attainment

Elementary	:	Consuelo Elementary School
Secondary	:	Holy Trinity College
Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Public Information Officer**